

Anarhichas lupus

Wolf-fish



Length Up to 5 ft (1.5 m)
Weight Up to 53 lb (24 kg)
Sex Male/Female
Status Not evaluated

Location North Atlantic, Arctic



The wolf-fish is a solitary predator that has no pelvic fins and only a rudimentary pelvic girdle. In contrast,

the teeth are very well developed: they are conical at the front of the jaws, and molarlike at the back. This fish uses its teeth and a bony plate in the roof of the mouth to crush mollusk shells and the carapaces of crabs, lobsters, sea urchins, and other echinoderms on which it feeds. Spawning takes place in deeper water during winter, and the eggs are guarded by the male until they hatch. Although originally caught only as a by-product of trawler fishing, the delicately flavored flesh of the wolf-fish has led to an increase in its commercial importance in recent years.



Naso lituratus

Orangespine unicornfish



Length 18 in (45 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location Pacific Ocean



The orangespine unicornfish belongs to a family of about 82 species known as surgeonfishes because of the knifelike spine or spines on the side of their tail. This species uses its

bright orange spines both in defense against predators and as a weapon in fights for dominance, inflicting deep wounds with rapid sideways swipes of the tail. The orangespine unicornfish has a moderately high, compressed body, but no hornlike projection on the forehead, unlike most other unicornfishes. It grazes on leafy algae attached to the seabed, nipping with its incisor teeth. A valued food source, it is caught off coral reefs.



Antennarius maculatus

Warty frogfish



Length Up to 4½ in (11.5 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Not evaluated

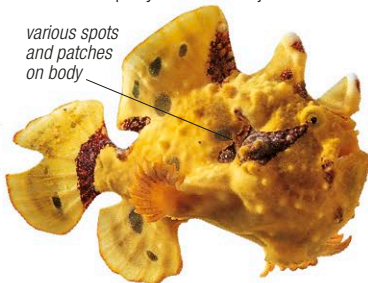
Location W. Pacific, Indian Ocean



This fish belongs to the anglerfish order—a group noted for their often bizarre appearance. Most anglerfishes

live in the deep sea, but frogfishes live in shallow water—at depths of only a few metres—usually in coral reefs. The warty frogfish's dorsal fin has a long spine that ends in a flap of colored skin, which the fish wriggles to mimic a small fish and so entice prey toward its jaws.

various spots and patches on body



Lophius piscatorius

Angler



Length Up to 6½ ft (2 m)
Weight Up to 88 lb (40 kg)
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location E. North Atlantic, Mediterranean, Black Sea



Also known as the monkfish, the angler is dull greenish brown, with a broad and flattened body that tapers rapidly toward the tail. A highly specialized sit-and-wait predator, it is very well camouflaged and has a fleshy lure on



its dorsal fin that can be suspended above its mouth. If anything swims close by, the fish opens its jaws and sucks it in. The outline of the body is hard to see because of the flaps of skin that fringe it. Spawning occurs between May and August depending on the locality. Each female produces up to one million eggs, which are released in a gelatinous sheet that floats at the surface. The bizarre-looking larvae that emerge from the eggs mature at different rates; males after 4 years and females after 6 years.

Histiophryne psychedelica

Psychedelic anglerfish



Length 6 in (15 cm) max
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Not evaluated

Location S.E. Asia



Frogfishes are almost spherical-shaped anglerfishes, characterized by thick folded skin and forward-facing eyes. This distinctive species—pinkish in color,

marked with white stripes and with a wide frilly face—was discovered among fishes destined for a public aquarium. In 2008, it was found living among coral rubble in shallows of Indonesian islands. Each fish has a unique pattern of stripes, and the fish “walks” on the seabed using its pectoral fins.



Histrio histrio

Sargassumfish



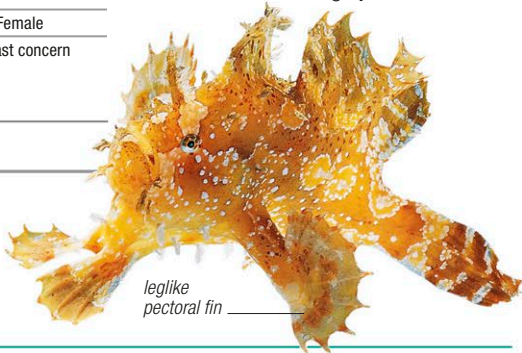
Length Up to 7½ in (18.5 cm)
Weight Up to 14 oz (400 g)
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location Tropical and subtropical seas worldwide



Superbly camouflaged, with highly variable coloring and patterns, this member of the frogfish family lives among drifting weed and is

hence very widely distributed. It hunts prey by using its dorsal fin spine as a lure. Sargassumfishes exhibit unusually elaborate courtship behavior, with the males violently nipping and chasing the females. Except in the spawning season, adults are highly cannibalistic.



Ceratias holboelli

Kroyer's deep-sea anglerfish



Length Female up to 3¼ ft (1 m)
Weight Up to 110 lb (50 kg)
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location Pacific, Atlantic, Indian Ocean



This fish shows an extraordinary difference between the sexes. The female (pictured) has a large head and mouth, but the male is tiny. When the adult male finds a mate, he bites into her flesh, and then lives parasitically on her. The pair's blood systems merge so that nutrients flow into the male's body; this bizarre lifestyle is found only in deep-sea anglers.

